THE AI-NATIVE CONTENT TEAM: HOW ANY TEAM CAN OUTPRODUCE (AND OUT-INNOVATE) THE COMPETITION



MIKE KAPUT

Chief Content Officer

SmarterX & Marketing AI Institute

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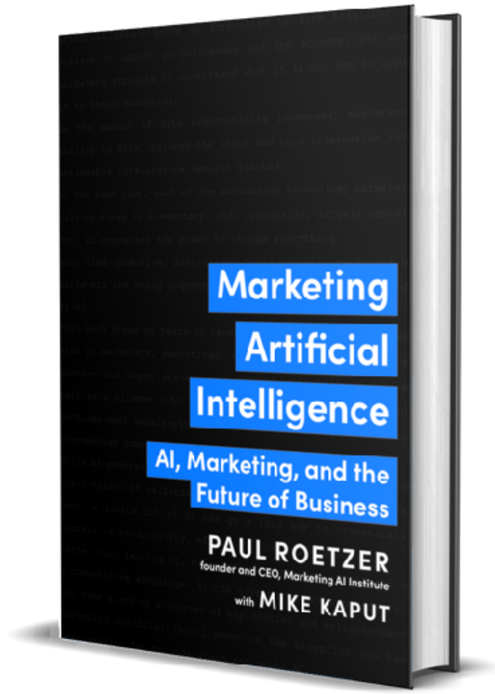
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Mike Kaput

mike@smarterx.ai

- Chief Content Officer, SmarterX
- Co-Author, *Marketing Artificial Intelligence*
- Co-Host, *The Artificial Intelligence Show*



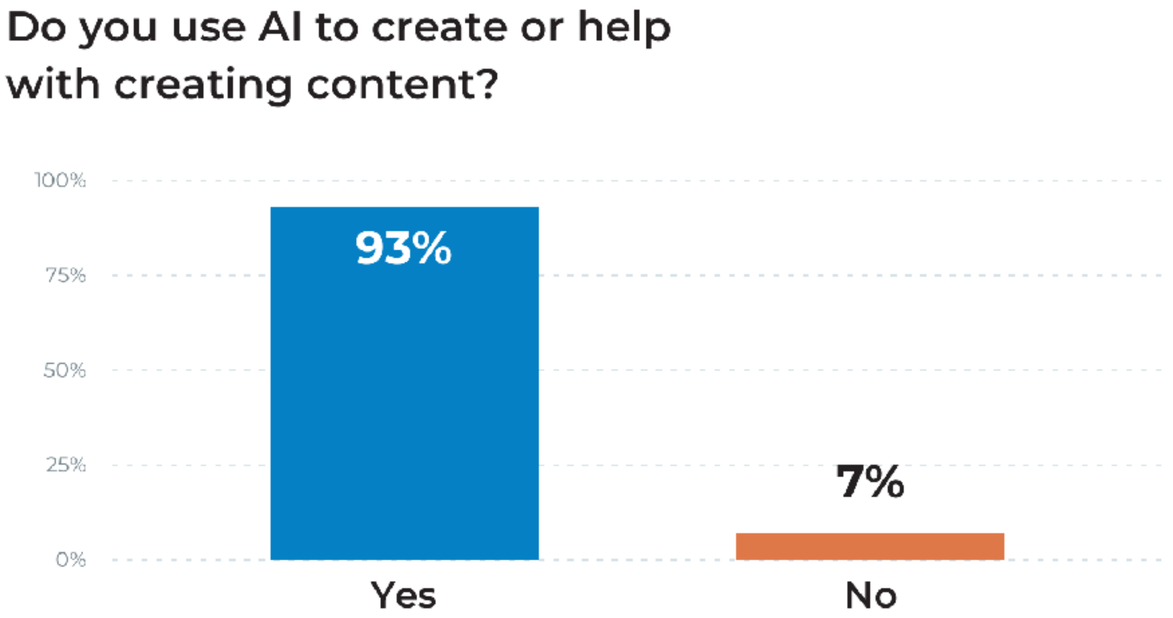
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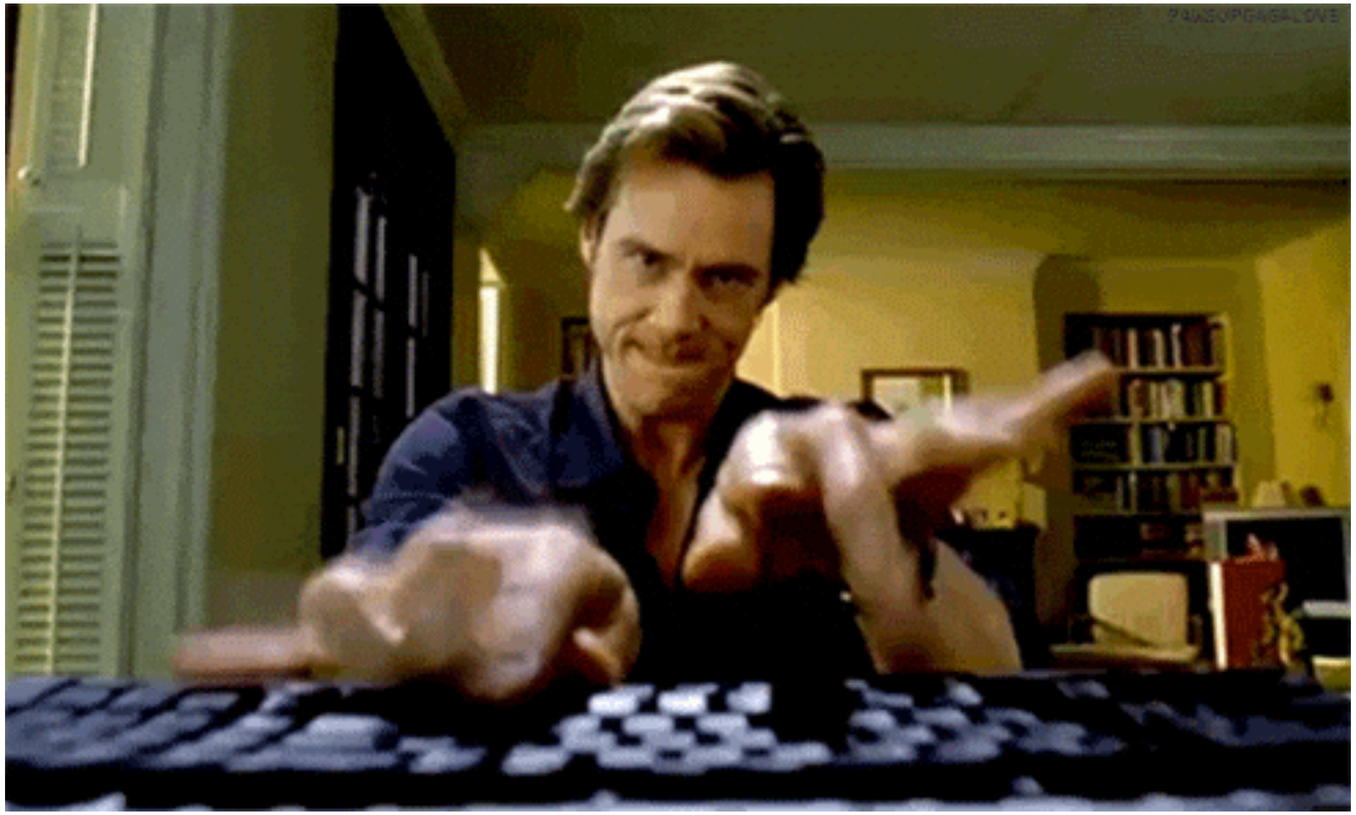
Marketers have adopted AI.



Source: Ahrefs, September 30, 2026

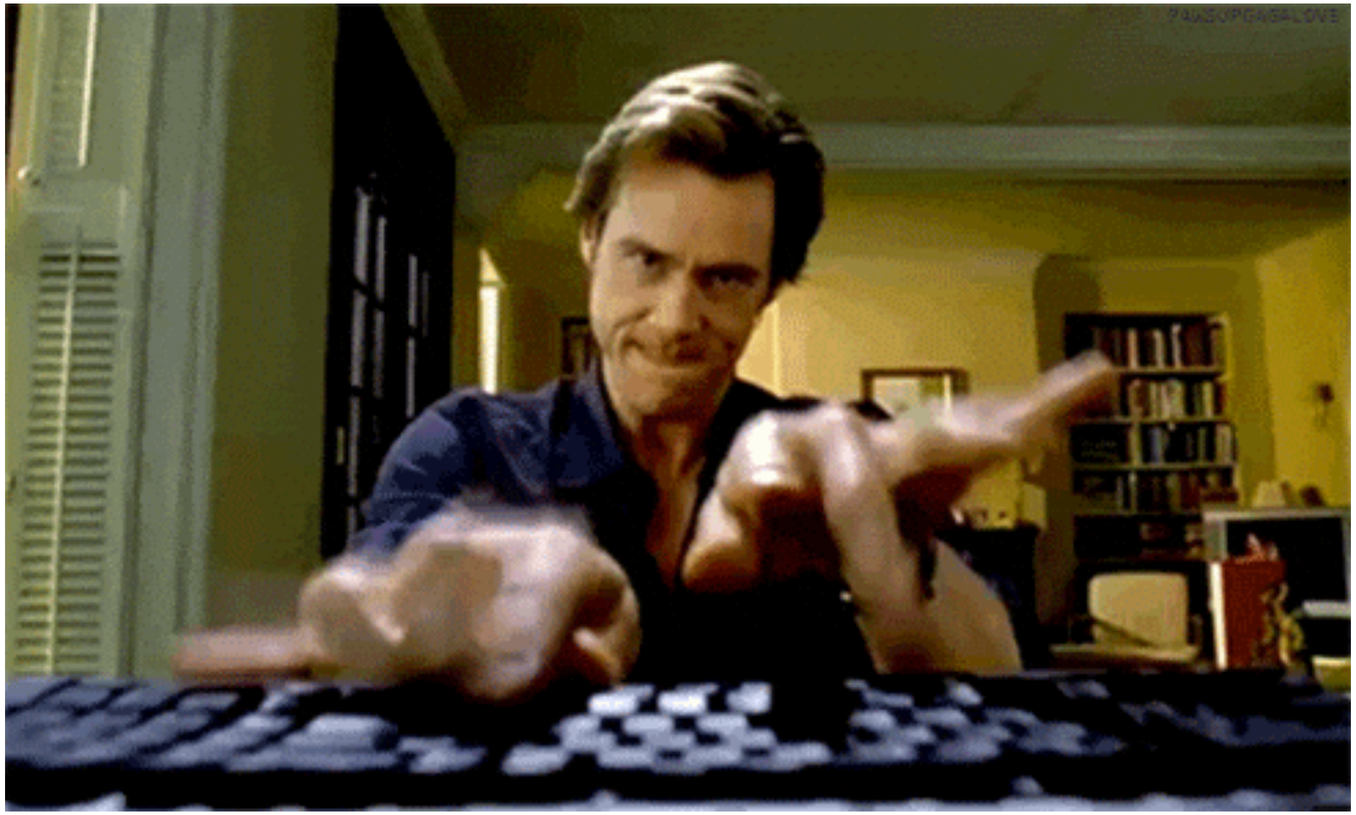
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But they haven’t *adapted* to AI.



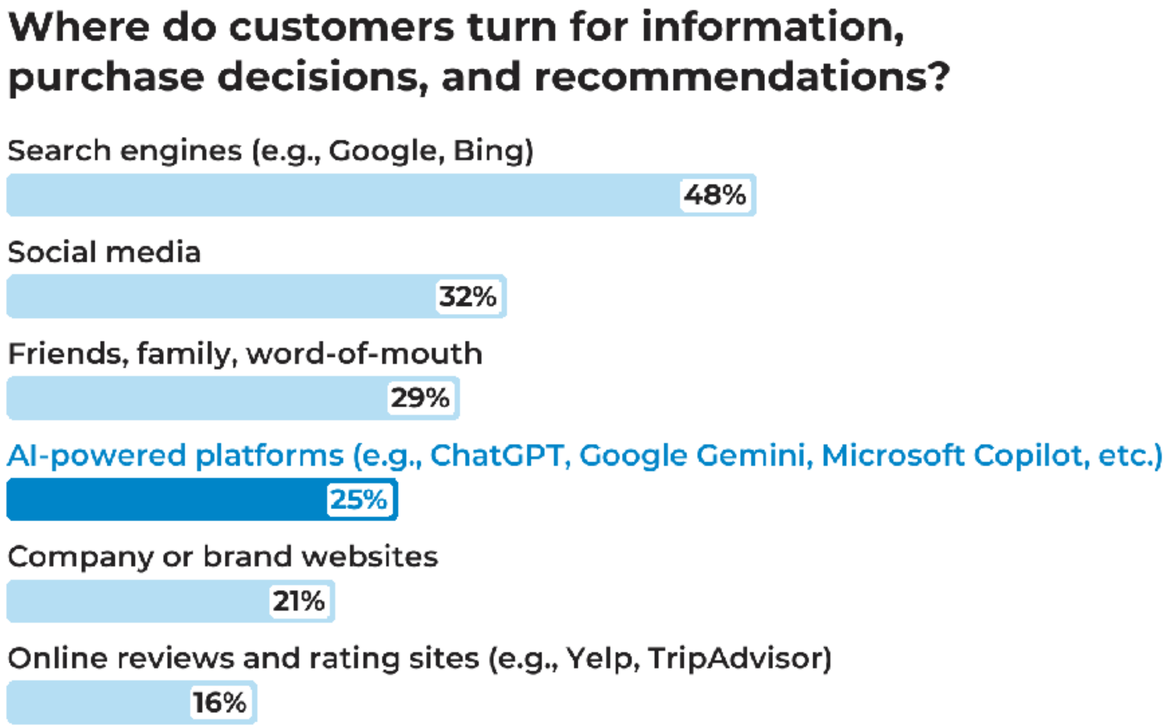
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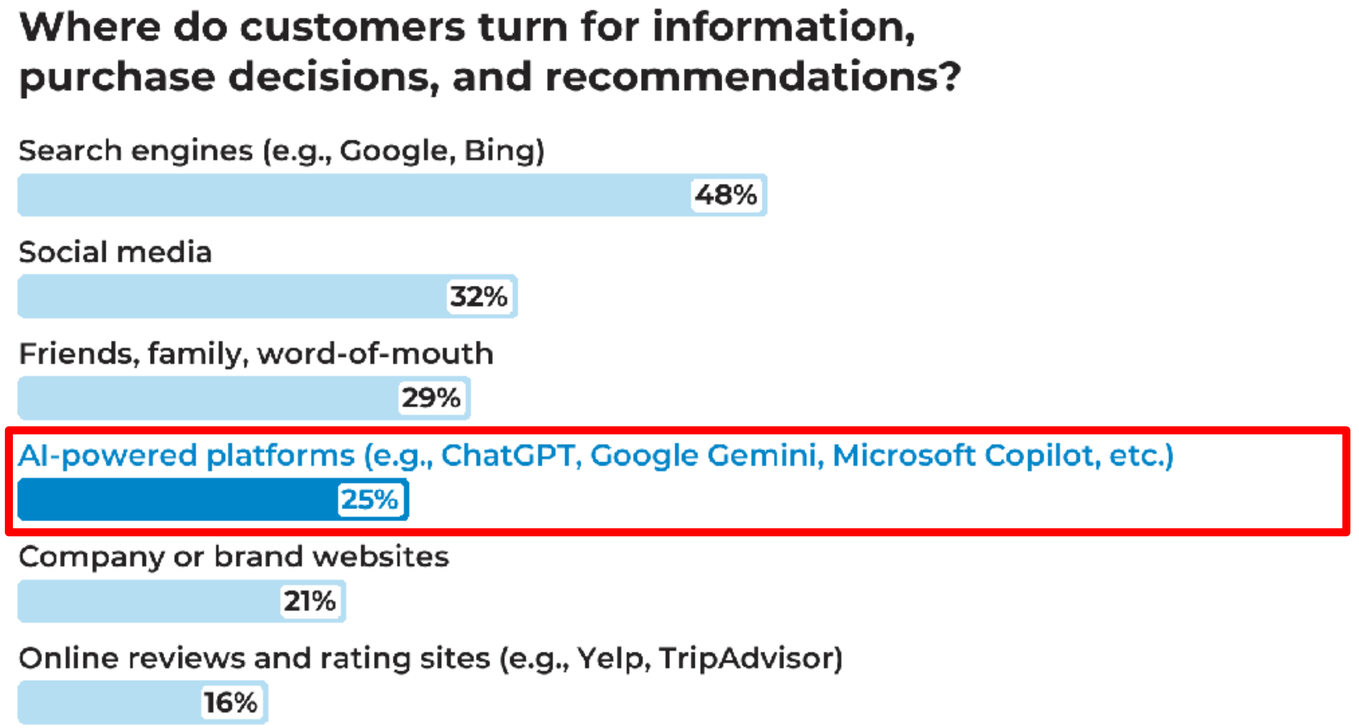
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Source: Adobe

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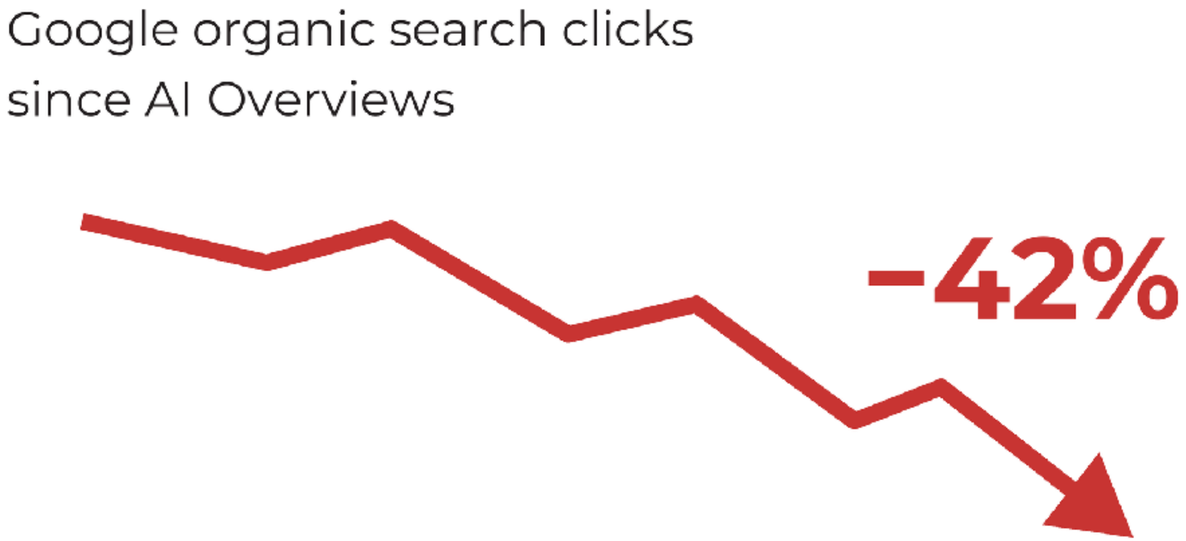
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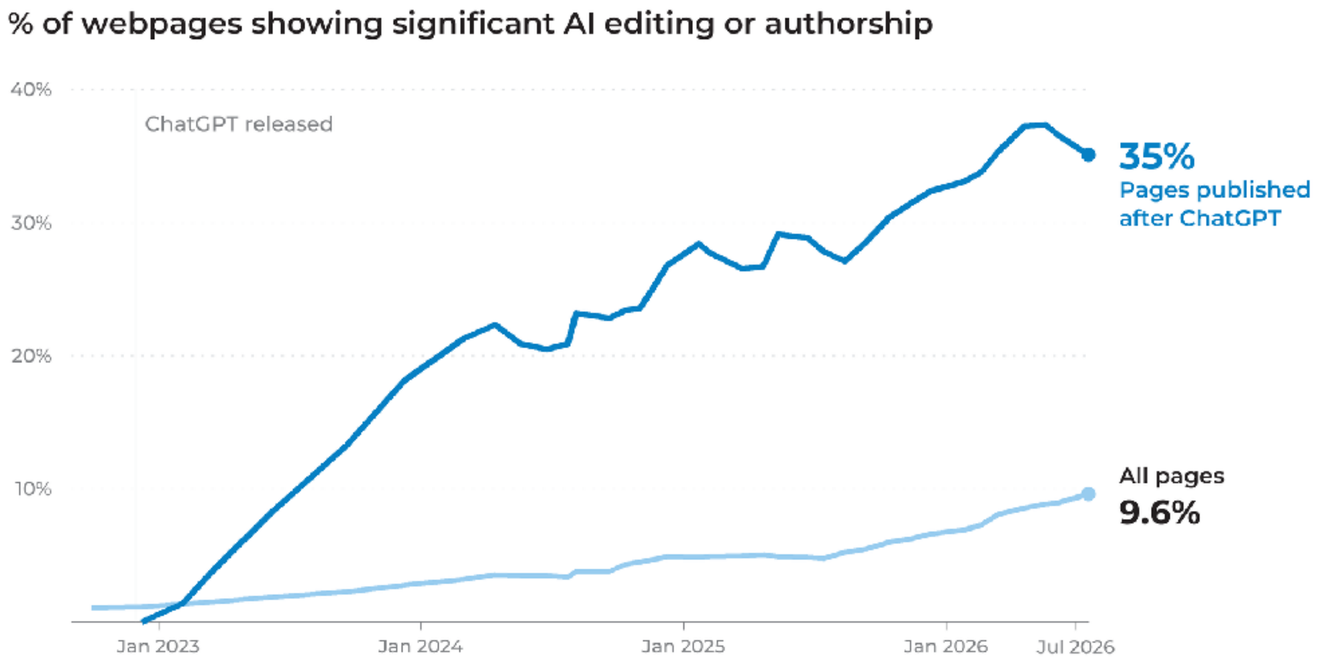
But they haven't *adapted* to AI.



Source: Define Media Group

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But they haven’t *adapted* to AI.



English-language webpages; post-ChatGPT series includes pages with publication dates.

Source: Pew Research Center, Aug. 2026

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Supply
(Content)
Demand
(Attention)



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Supply
(Content)
Demand
(Attention)



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We need a totally new playbook.

- Create only what AI can't
- Scale only as AI can
- Reinvent what content does

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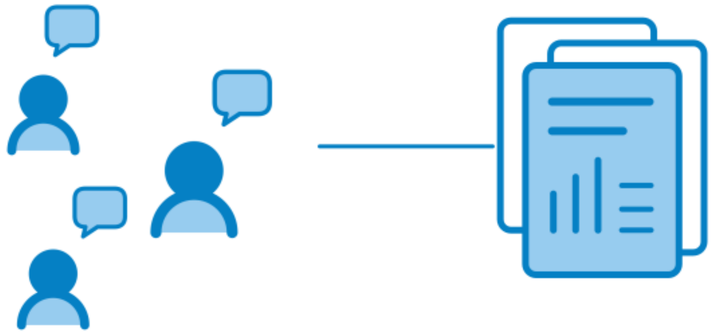
The AI-Native Content Playbook



1 Original Inputs

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The AI-Native Content Playbook



2 Anchor Assets

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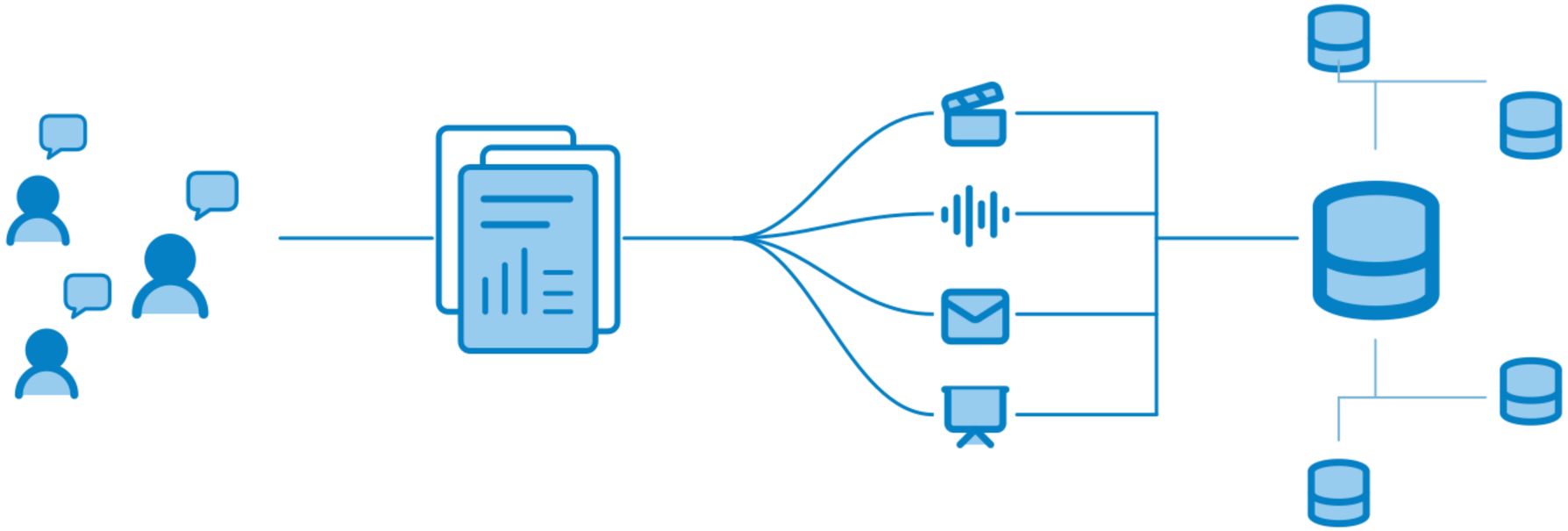
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3 Content Portfolio

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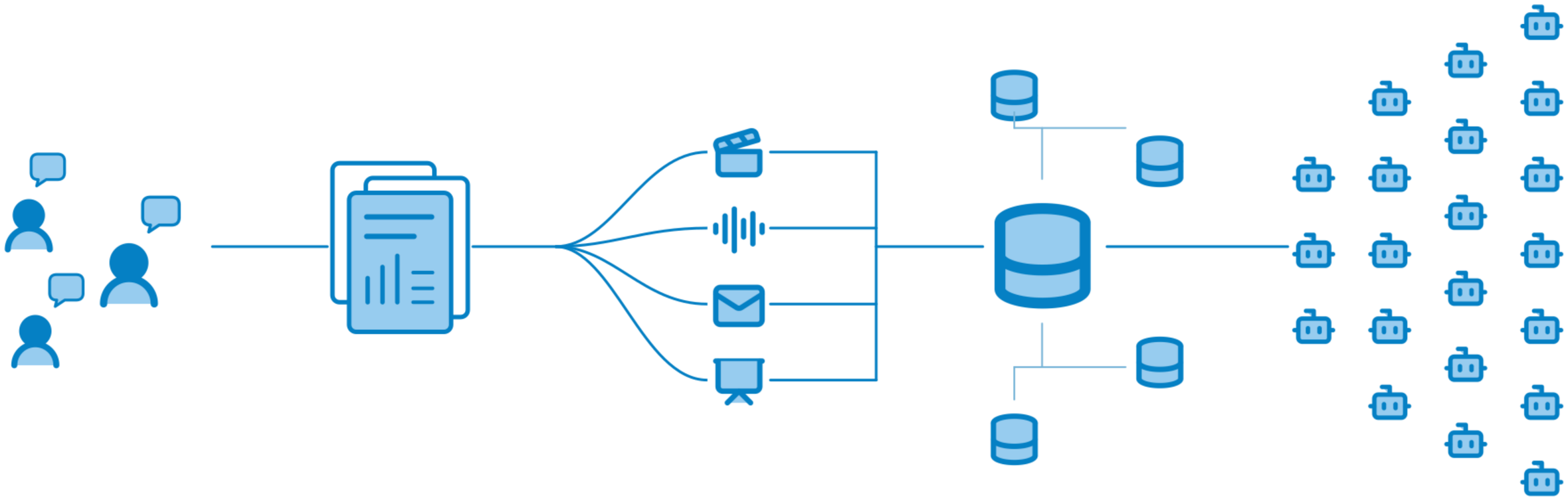
The AI-Native Content Playbook



4 Living Knowledge

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The AI-Native Content Playbook



5 Agentic Engine

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The AI-Native Content Playbook



1 Original Inputs

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Original inputs are human insights, data, and ideas AI can’t supply on its own.



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- Expert Interviews
- Original Data
- Proprietary Frameworks
- Lived Experience
- Customer Conversations



How It Works

1. Use **top reasoning models (ex: Fable, Astra) + human experts** to shape editorial strategy.

2. Use models as **true strategic thought partners** to design research, interviews, and outreach.

3. Capture and process insights via **voice AI tools (ex: Granola, Otter, Wispr Flow)**.

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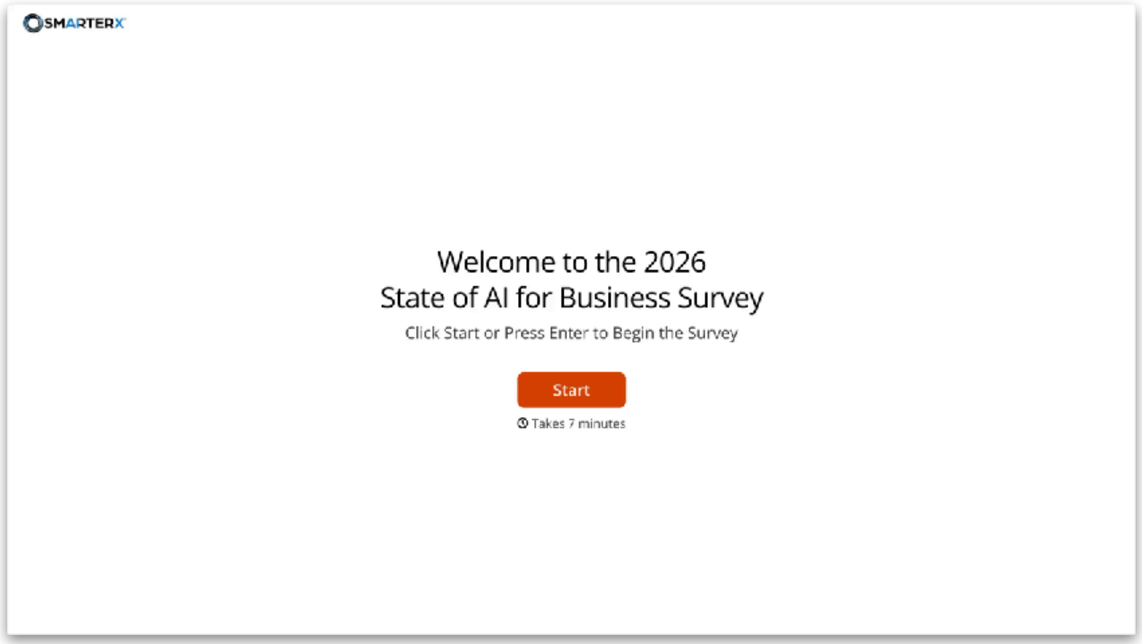
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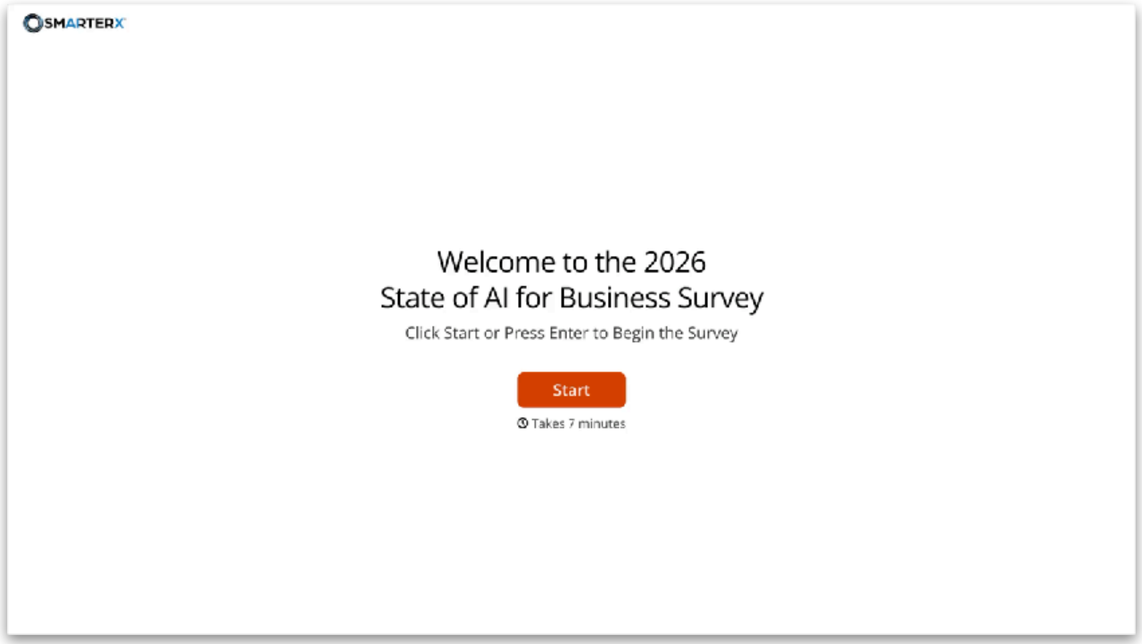
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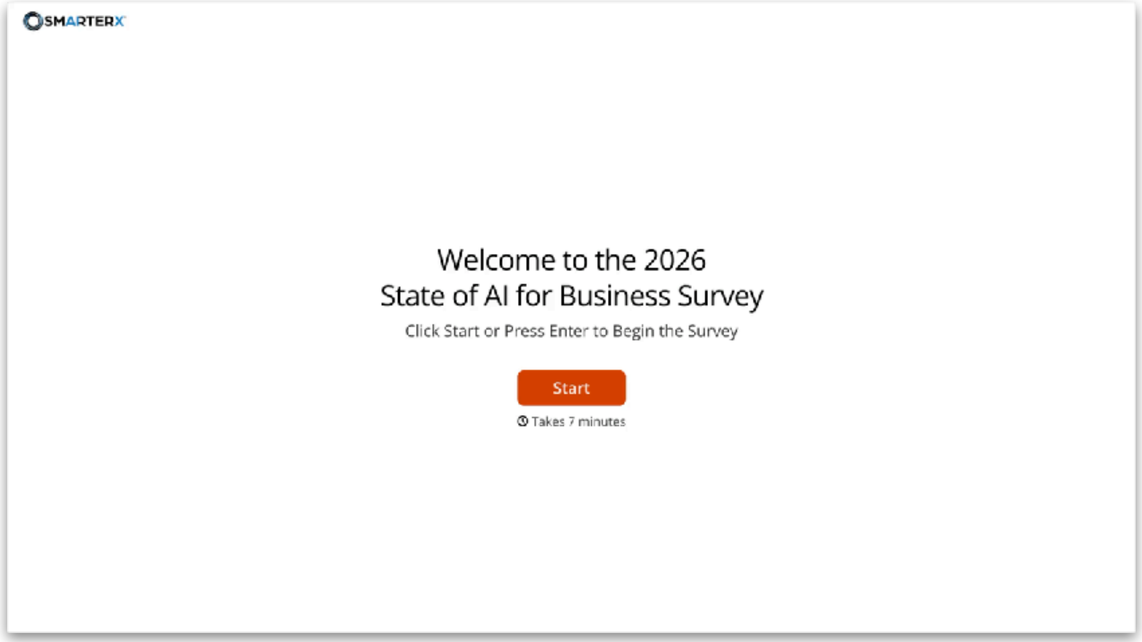
- 34 questions
- 2,100 respondents
- 100,000+ unique data points

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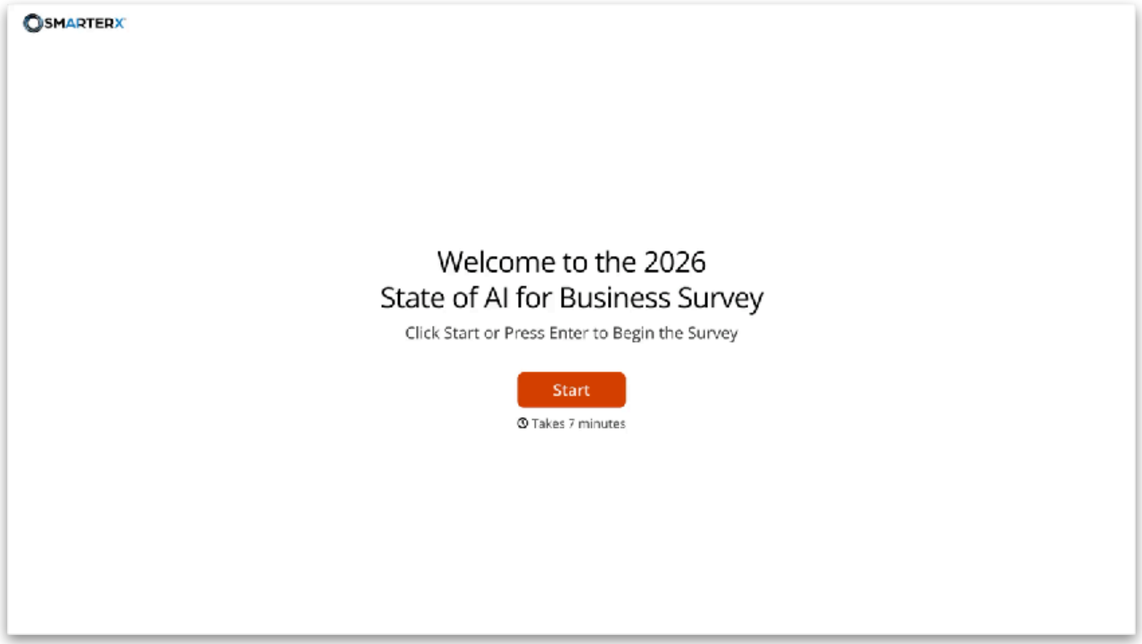
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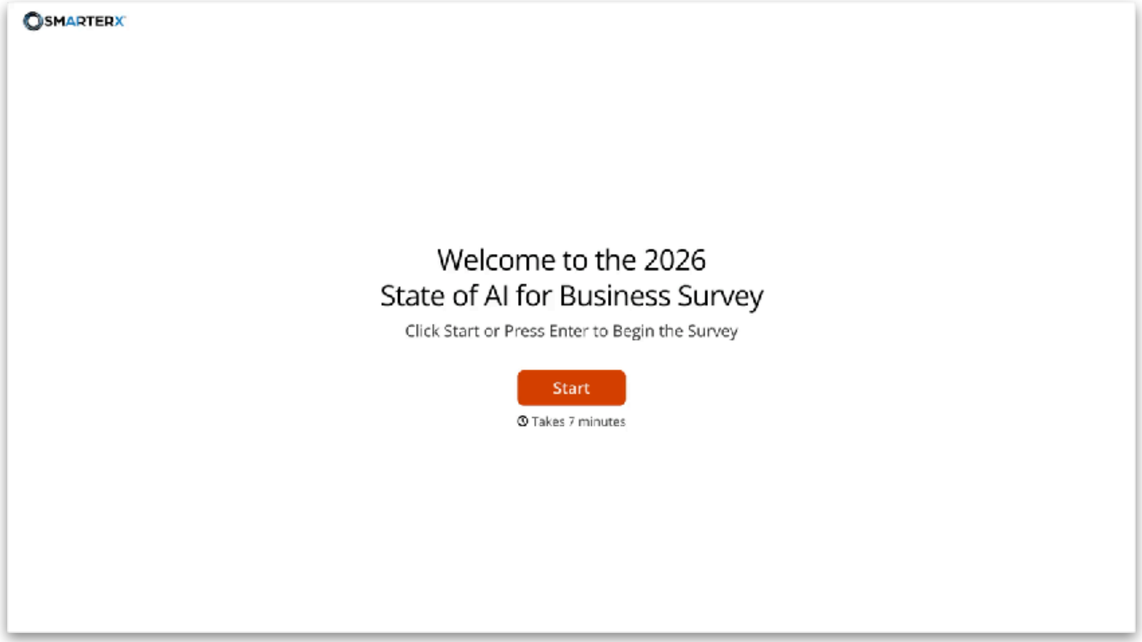
"I feel like I'm falling behind every day, even though most would consider me an advanced user."

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"What do I tell my kids to pursue in terms of education and profession?"

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"I feel like I can do anything, especially the hard stuff that would've scared me before."

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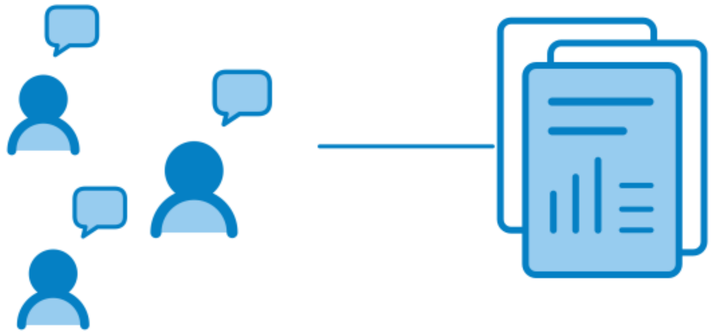
The AI-Native Content Playbook



2 Anchor Assets

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The AI-Native Content Playbook



2 Anchor Assets

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Original inputs become **anchor assets**, or individual pieces of work that we draw from and point back to.



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- Research Reports
- Podcast Episodes
- Webinars
- Videos
- In-Depth Guides



How It Works

1. Build **reusable skills to teach AI** your editorial standards, voice, and process for longer-form content.

2. Collaborate with **agentic systems (ex: Claude Code, Codex)** to build anchor assets using reusable skills.

3. Use **verification agents + human judgment** to edit the work for accuracy, quality, and taste.

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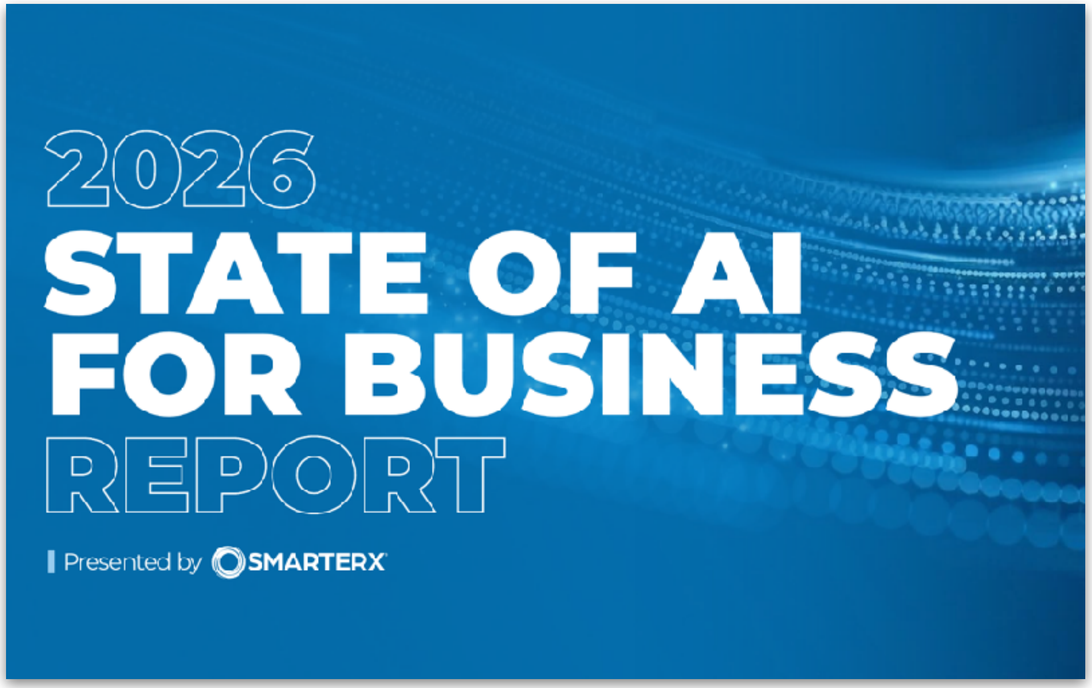
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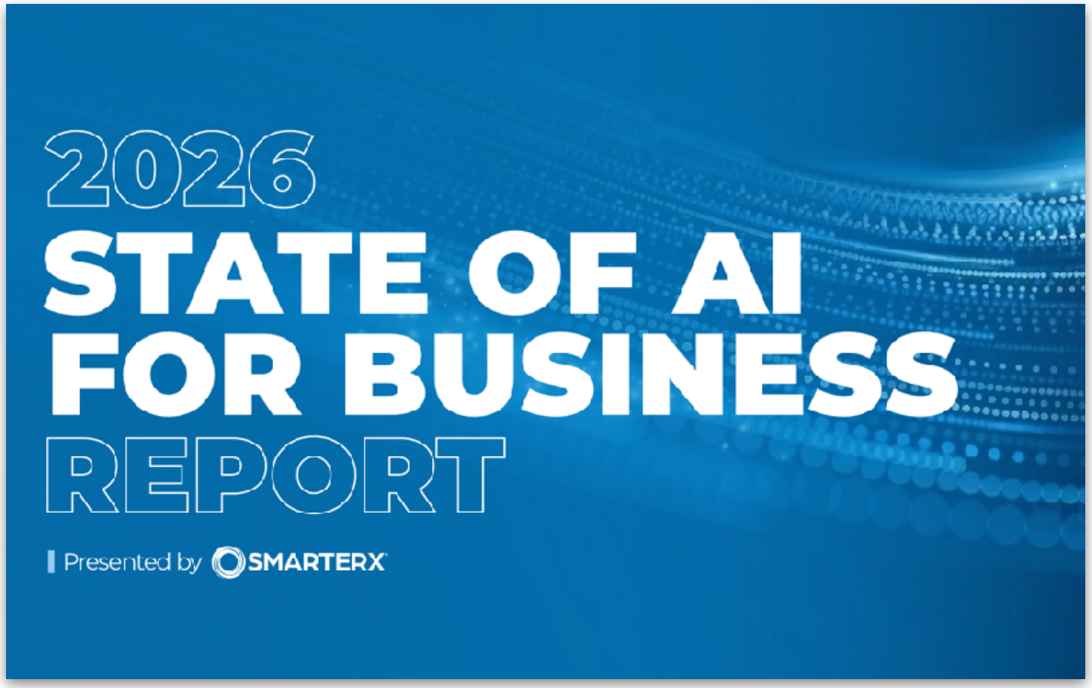
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Time to a design-ready draft

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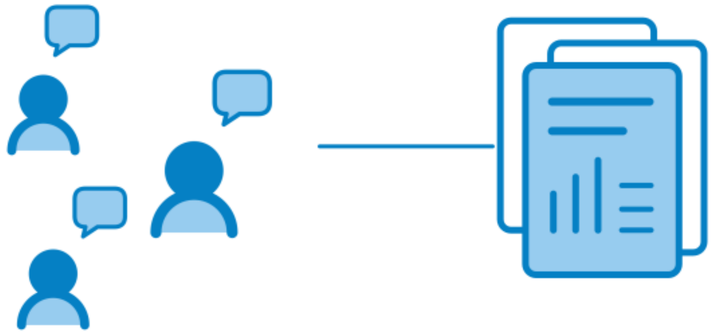
Time to a design-ready draft

Before AI — 4 weeks

After AI — 1 week

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The AI-Native Content Playbook



3 Content Portfolio

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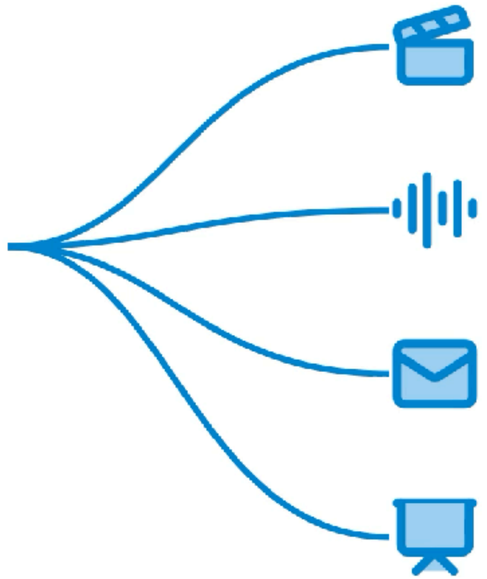
The AI-Native Content Playbook



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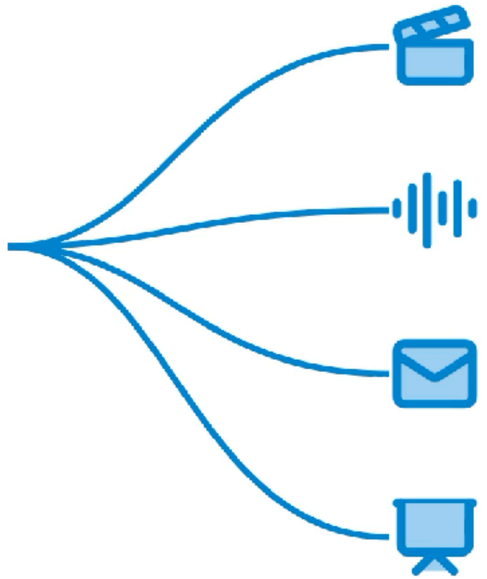
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Each anchor asset becomes a **content portfolio** of assets for different formats, channels, and teams.



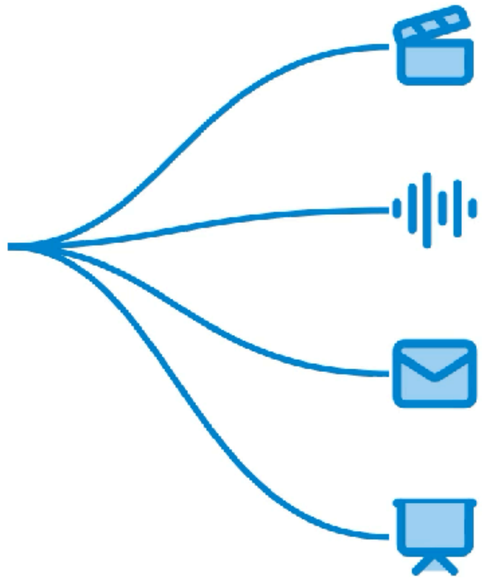
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- Blog Posts
- Social Posts
- Short Video Clips
- Email Campaigns
- Sales Enablement Materials
- Training Resources



How It Works

1. Build **skills, assistants, projects, or apps** to automatically repurpose anchors across channels, audiences, and formats.

2. Create **images, audio, and video** with specialized AI tools **(ex: Midjourney, ElevenLabs, HeyGen)**.

3. **Distribute content automatically** by connecting AI to platforms, apps, and browsers **(ex: Computer Use, Browser Use)**.

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HOW IMPORTANT IS AI TO THEIR SUCCESS IN THE NEXT YEAR?

Three-quarters of respondents say AI is critically or very important.

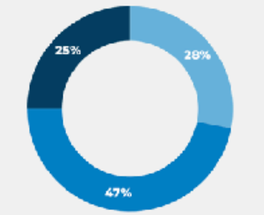
How important is AI to the success of your organization over the next 12 months?



WHAT IS THEIR ORGANIZATION'S STAGE OF AI TRANSFORMATION?

Nearly half of organizations remain in the Piloting phase. Only one in four has reached Scaling.

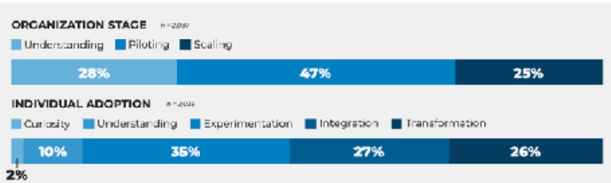
Which stage of AI transformation best describes your organization?



This is where the gap between individuals and organizations becomes unmistakable.

While 53% of individuals say they're in Integration or Transformation, only 25% say their organization has reached the Scaling phase. The largest share (47%) say their organization is still Piloting, prioritizing and running a limited number of pilot projects with narrowly defined use cases. And 28% say their organization is still in Understanding, just learning how AI works and exploring technologies.

The structural implication is significant. The majority of organizations are still treating AI as a project, not a capability. They're running experiments without the infrastructure to turn successful pilots into scaled practices.



The middle market is stuck. Scaling rates vary dramatically by company size. The smallest firms ($0–$11M revenue; 32% Scaling) and the largest ($1B+; 30% Scaling) are most likely to have reached the Scaling phase. But the middle market (firms with $50M to $500M in revenue) reports Scaling rates of just 14% to 16%. These organizations may face the worst of both worlds: too large for CEO-driven agility, too small for dedicated enterprise AI teams.

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- Articles
- Visuals and Charts
- Podcast Episodes
- Social Shares
- Stat Spotlights
- Activation Briefs
- Interactive Tools

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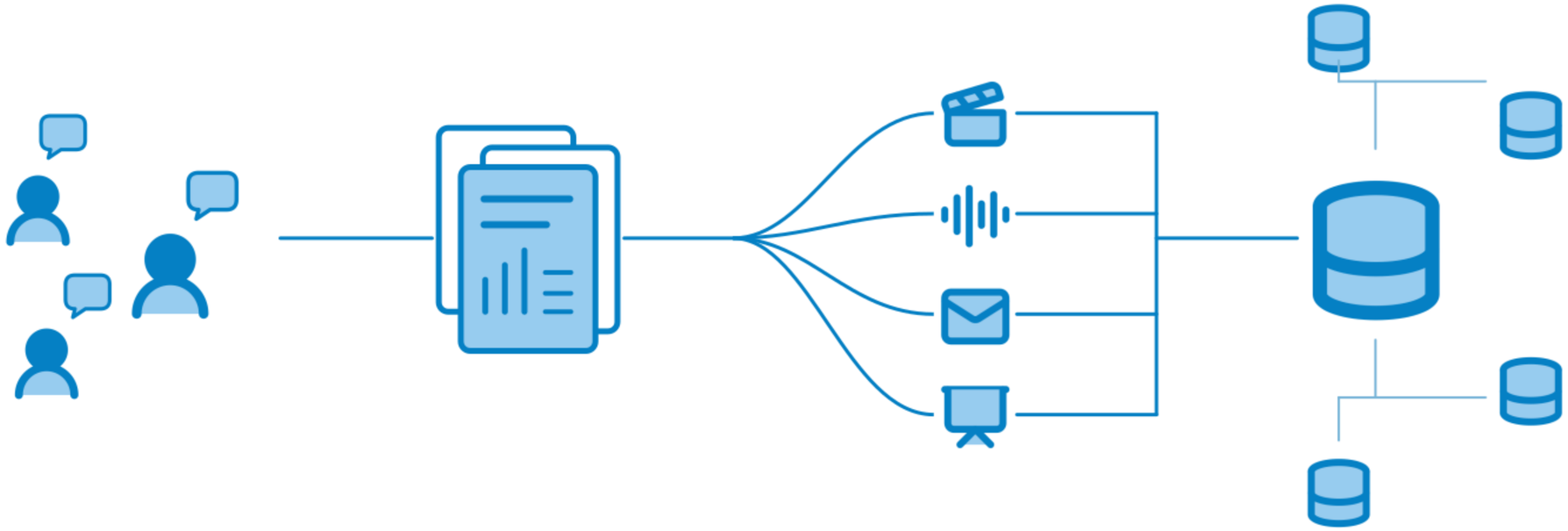
The AI-Native Content Playbook



4 Living Knowledge

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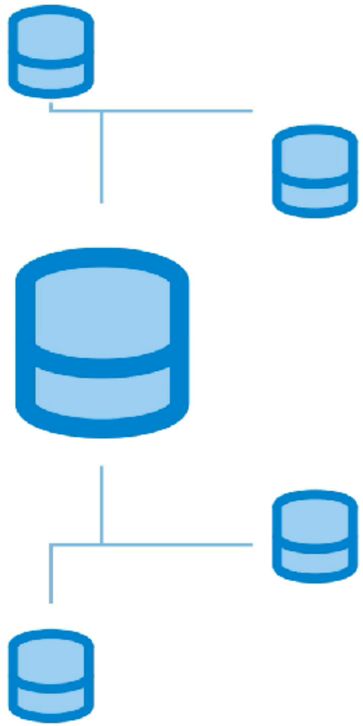
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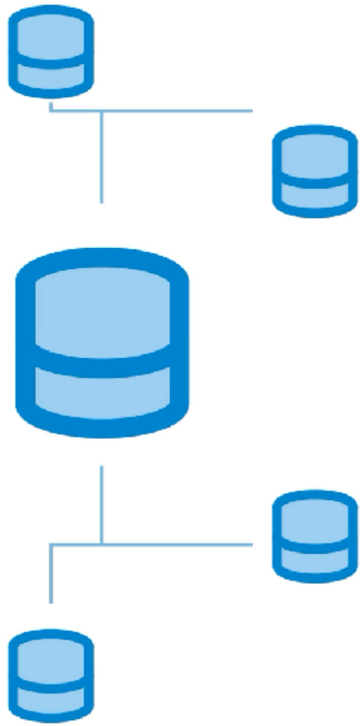
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Content portfolios become
living knowledge in shared collections
that AI and humans can query.



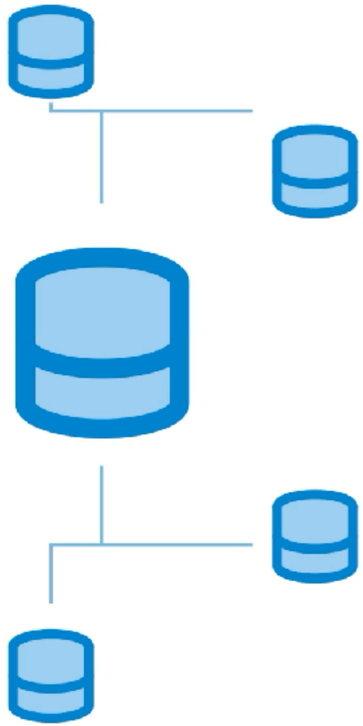
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- Podcast Archive
- Course Library
- Research Database
- Intellectual Property Hub
- Voice of Customer Hub



How It Works

1. Create **shared repositories (ex: Google Drive, Notion)** to centralize content and data.

2. **Point AI at repositories** using integrations, connectors, MCPs, etc.

3. Use **recurring AI workflows (ex: Gemini Enterprise)** to automatically update and maintain knowledge.

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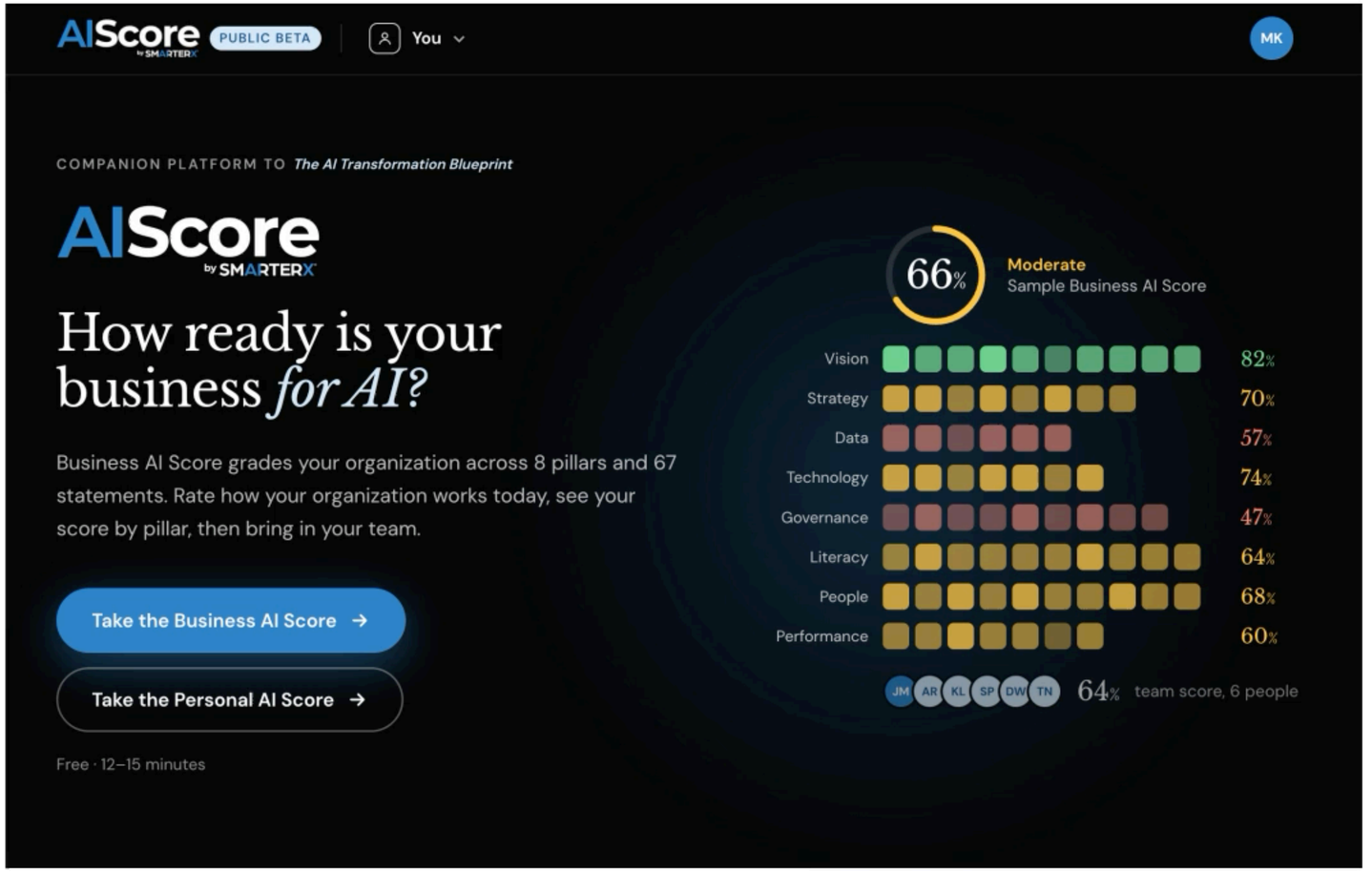
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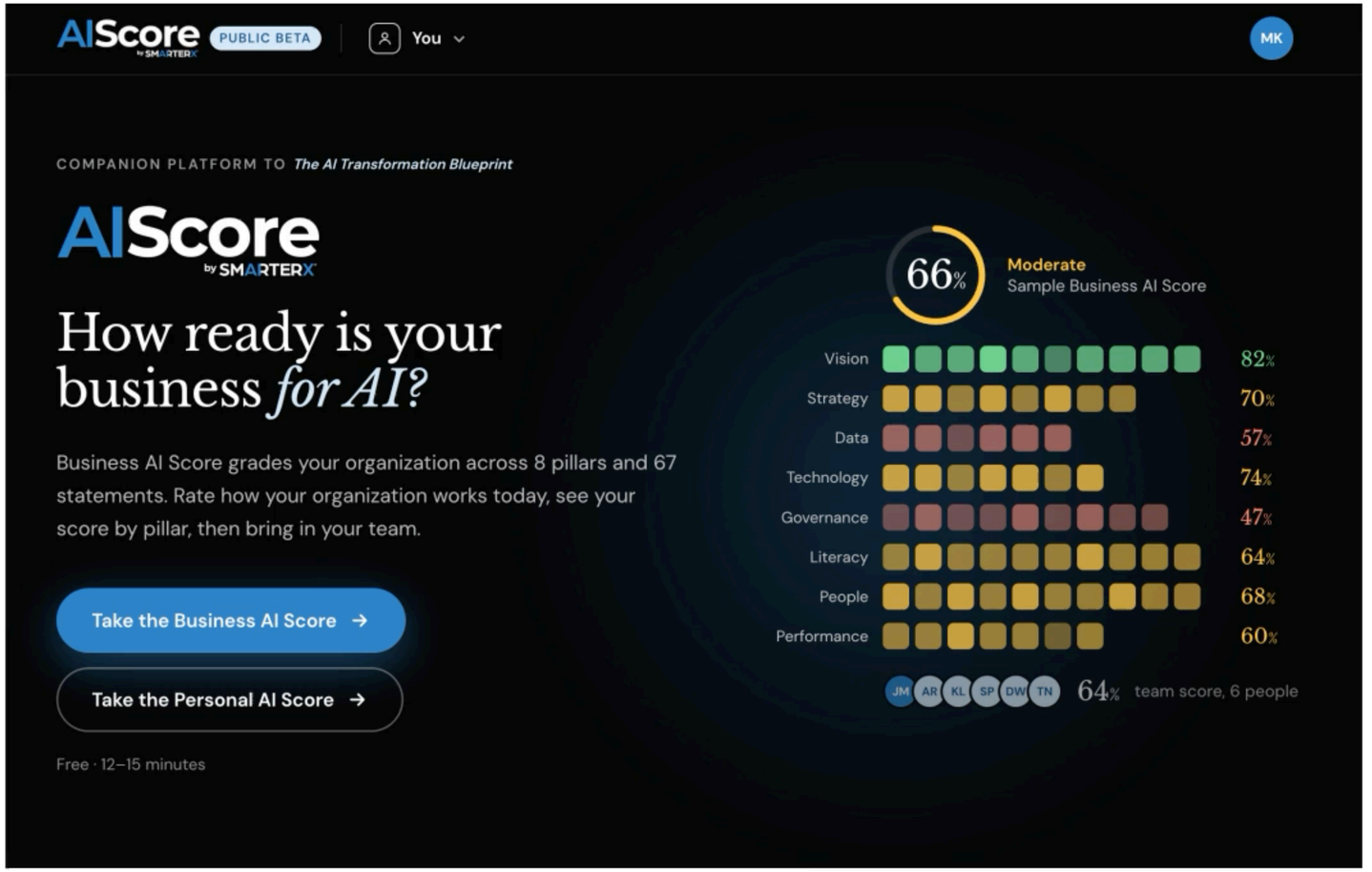
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2026
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AIScore by SMARTERX PUBLIC BETA
You
MK
COMPANION PLATFORM TO The AI Transformation Blueprint
AIScore by SMARTERX
How ready is your business for AI?
Business AI Score grades your organization across 8 pillars and 67 statements. Rate how your organization works today, see your score by pillar, then bring in your team.
Take the Business AI Score →
Take the Personal AI Score →
Free · 12–15 minutes
66%
Moderate
Sample Business AI Score
Vision 82%
Strategy 70%
Data 57%
Technology 74%
Governance 47%
Literacy 64%
People 68%
Performance 60%
JM AR KL SP DW TN
64% team score, 6 people

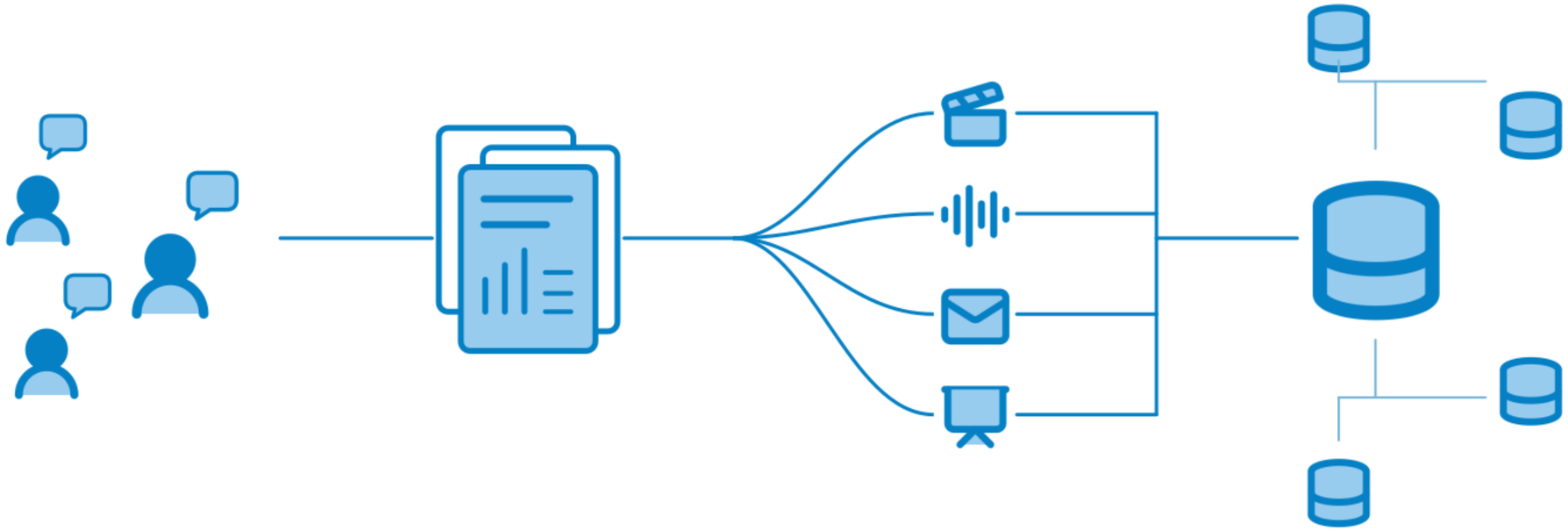
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How ready is your business for AI?
Business AI Score grades your organization across 8 pillars and 67 statements. Rate how your organization works today, see your score by pillar, then bring in your team.
Take the Business AI Score →
Take the Personal AI Score →
Free · 12–15 minutes
66%
Moderate
Sample Business AI Score
Vision 82%
Strategy 70%
Data 57%
Technology 74%
Governance 47%
Literacy 64%
People 68%
Performance 60%
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64% team score, 6 people

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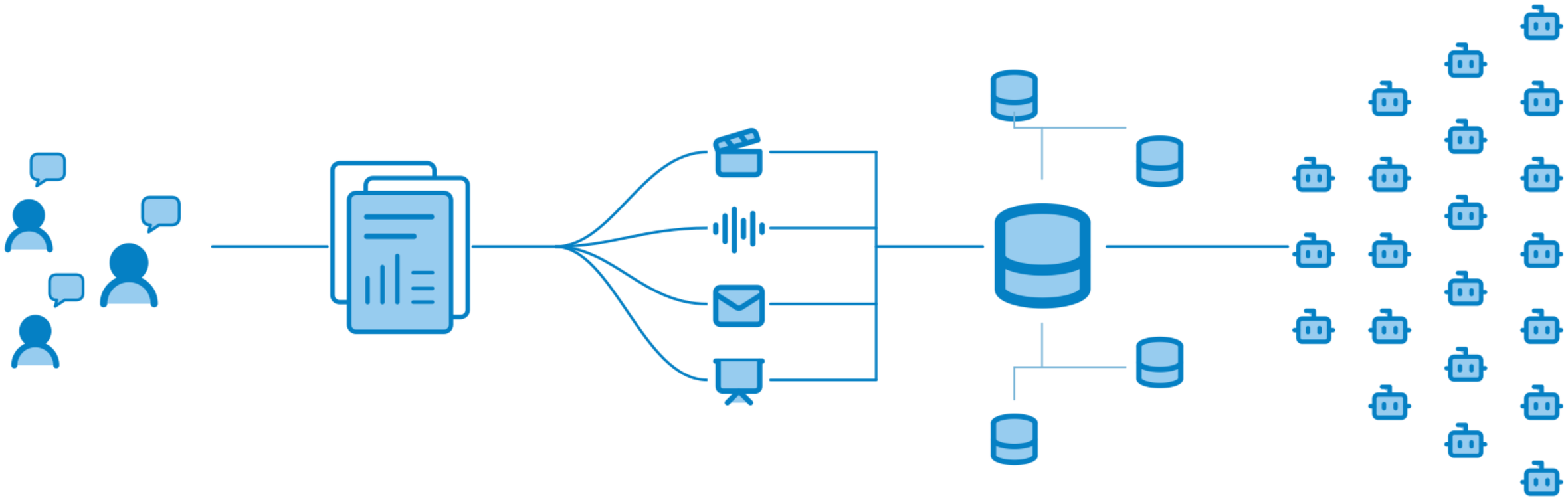
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5 Agentic Engine

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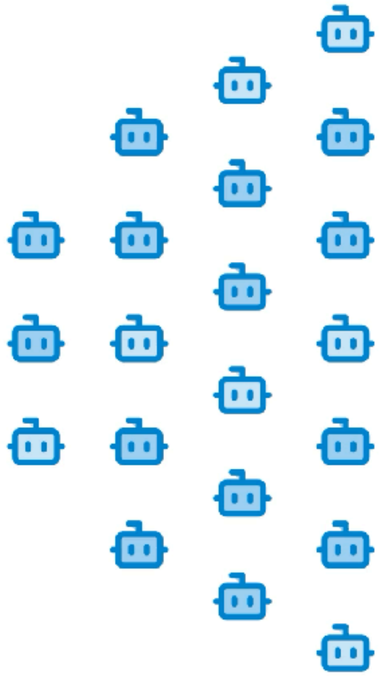
The AI-Native Content Playbook



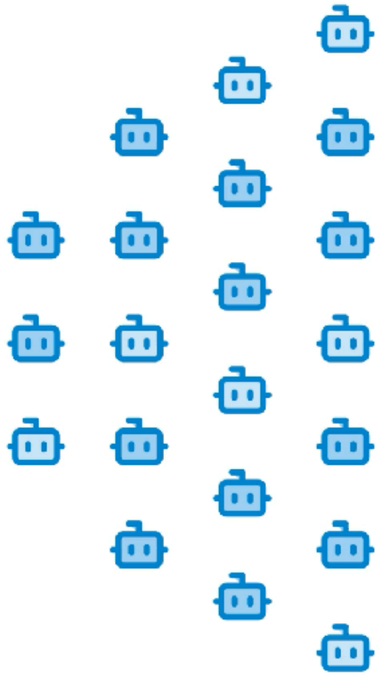
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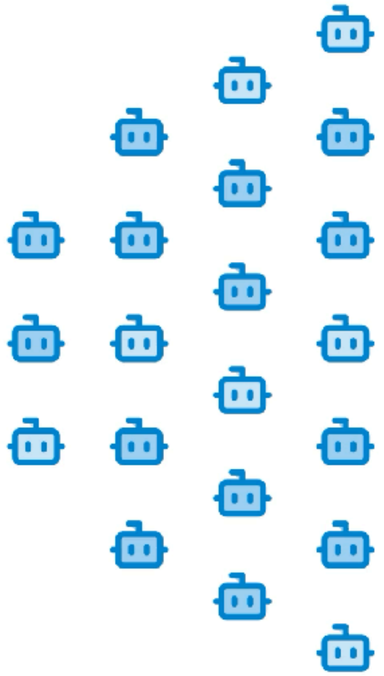
Living knowledge is then used by an **agentic engine** that proactively monitors, recommends, and creates.



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- Monitoring Agents
- Strategy Agents
- Creation Agents
- Distribution Agents
- Performance Agents



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How It Works

1 **Connect agents (ex: OpenClaw, Hermes)** to living knowledge.

2 **Set up recurring tasks for agents** to carry out using that knowledge. (**Ex: Scheduled Tasks**)

3 Give agents **ongoing goals and boundaries** so they can propose and act on new content opportunities.

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Editorial agent
Monitoring agent
Production agent
YOUR WEBSITE
Published
FROM SMARTERX AI ACADEMY
How We Train Teams on AI:
Lessons From Thousands of Learners
Human experience
Human approval
Feedback agent
Verification agent

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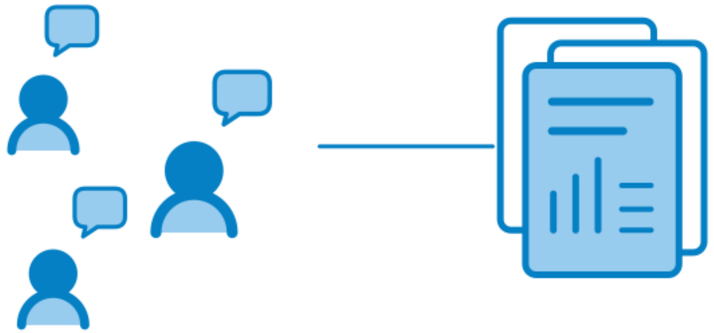
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1 Original Inputs

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2 Anchor Assets

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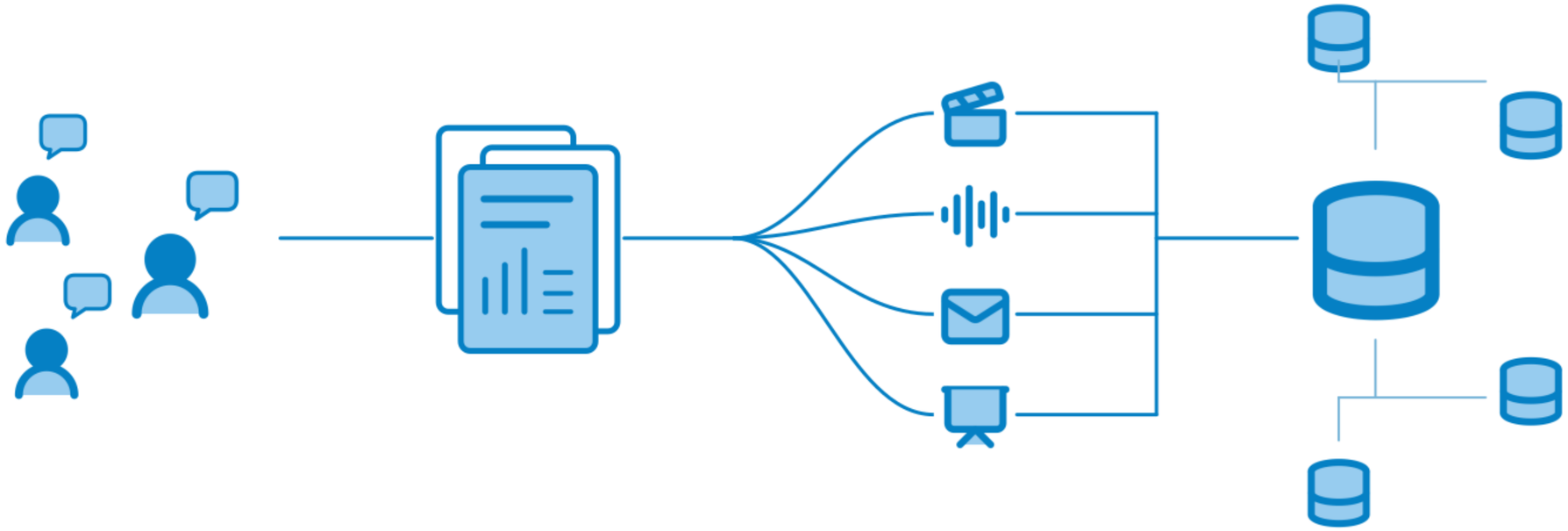
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3 Content Portfolio

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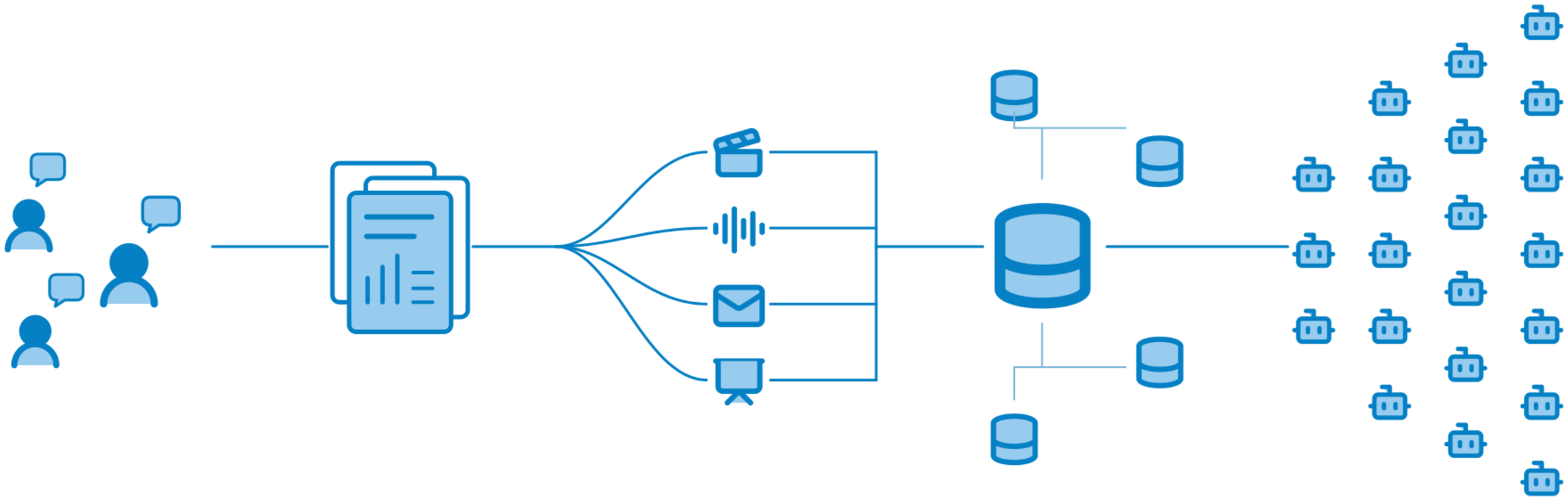
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4 Living Knowledge

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5 Agentic Engine

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What We’re Learning

1. Your job is now to get **as close to people as possible**.

2. You're building **compounding systems, not individual assets**.

3. **Managing agents** is becoming part of the job.

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MAICON FORWARD

MIKE KAPUT

Chief Content Officer

SmarterX & Marketing AI Institute

THANK YOU! WE APPRECIATE YOUR SESSION FEEDBACK.